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Apple iPhone 6S

A touch of change

The iPhone 6S looks almost identical to iPhone 6, with only the small 'S' below the iPhone logo on the back indicating the difference. That is, unless you bought the metallic pink version, or Rose Gold, as Apple calls it. It took me a while to realise this, but the Rose Gold version actually looks golden under some lights, especially halogen bulbs, perhaps why Apple chose the name.

What you see is also what you get here. The iPhone 6S is slightly thicker, to accommodate the new 3D Touch and, as the new alloy that Apple has used to avoid bendgate issues. It's also heavier than the iPhone 6. While the weight is pretty apparent with this one, the thickness is something that only an iPhone 6 user would be able to tell on first look. What the thickness and added weight does is help you to get a better grip of the phone and make it feel sturdier.

What's changed though is the performance. If you're a gamer, you would love this phone. The new hexa-core PowerVR GT7600 GPU achieves frame rates that are higher than what the refresh rate of the display is. That is something few phones, if any, can boast today. While the best performing Android phones achieve about 950-1000 frames on the GFX Bench Manhattan OnScreen test, the iPhone 6S goes well over 3,000. If you had any questions about whether this phone is a beast for gaming, this fact alone should answer those.

Day to day performance of the 6S is also good. The A9 processor inside does well, but it's nothing out of the ordinary for Apple, and nothing that we haven't seen from iPhones before. It's more powerful yes, but not really as visibly as you would want it to be. My unit hung when opening the camera quite often, but that should be a glitch in iOS and not a performance issue.

The new 12MP camera is also better than Apple's earlier 8MP iSight cameras. That said, it's one department where, for the first time, Apple needs to improve. Android OEMs have caught up, if not surpassed the iPhone's camera. While the iPhone 6S does very well and will not disappoint



Price
₹62,000
(16GB)

even the most camera savvy users, from a purely comparative point of view, it needs to do better. Photos taken from this one are true to source and reasonably good on details, but low light performance falters against the LG G4.

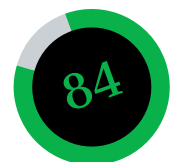
Coming to the 'new' feature in the iPhone 6S, the 3D Touch. It's new indeed, but frankly, it's not as impressive as suggested. I was used to it after the first two to three tries, but I don't really find it making a big difference in terms of usefulness just yet. In addition, 3D Touch doesn't work inside Spotlight or the new Google Now-like screen either, meaning I still have to search for my apps and then pressure press, instead of just press.

The good thing though is that quite a few apps, like PayTM, Zomato etc. have added the feature, which means it's only a matter of time till someone truly innovates with 3D Touch. It's a new feature, yes, but not one that really adds functionality right now. We've learned to trust Apple to get developers excited though, haven't we?

Moving on, Apple also reduced the battery capacity of the iPhone 6S by about 100 mAh compared to the iPhone 6. That doesn't really make a difference in the battery life though, and if you found the iPhone 6 to be lacking battery life, this one would do the same. On a regular work day, the phone can last you for just about a full day, while heavier usage and extensive gaming would mean you'll have to charge the phone more often. On the first day of using the phone, we lost 50% battery in three hours, thanks to quite intensive usage, including streaming videos for about 30 minutes, playing games for a little longer and lots of calls. The new Low Power mode kicks in at 20% battery, and helps the phone last a bit longer than it otherwise would.

Overall, the Apple iPhone 6S is definitely a good phone, as long as you're upgrading from an iPhone 5 or below. While iPhone 5S users can consider it too, we would suggest sticking to your phone for another year for a more worthy upgrade next year.

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Specifications

Processor: 1.84GHz Apple A9 Dual-Core; **Operating System:** iOS 9.0.2; **Display:** 4.7 inch, 750x1334 pixels; **Battery:** 1715 mAh; **Camera:** 12MP rear, 5MP front; **RAM:** 2GB; **Storage:** 16/64/128 GB

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